

LOL MOMENTS IN TECH

Read on for classic epic fails, facepalms and other lowpoints in tech

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There are times when great things happen for companies, and those are moments they will cherish forever. It defines the companies themselves, and the perception of greatness is etched into our memories forever. These are not those stories.

Nokia's FakeView facepalm

Nokia Lumia 920 which is the company's flagship Windows Phone, was supposed to be the talk of the town. The specs were great: Windows Phone 8 OS compatibility, Snapdragon S4 SoC, 8.7MP PureView camera



Reflection showing high end camera setup

and so on. But instead, all we remember is the 'fake' promotional video. For a company that's struggling with its refreshed line-up of phones, this was the last thing they needed. The video shows a couple, presumably in love, riding on bicycles on an empty road. The guy is 'allegedly' shooting the girl with his Lumia 920 phone. It even has the split-screen view showing the Optical Image

Stabilization feature in 'On' and 'Off' modes. Some video editor somewhere forgot that even clear glass reflects in bright daylight, and when the scene passes a trailer, in the window you see a reflection of a jeep with a professional camera shooting the girl, and not the Lumia 920! Bam! Websites were quick to pounce on that blink-and-you-miss-it frame which eventually led to Nokia issuing an apology and stating on record that the promotional video wasn't shot on the Lumia 920. Last we heard, Nokia is looking for a video editing guy.

RIM planning a flash mob outside an Apple store

Let's wind the clock back to the first week of May, when we woke up to news of flash-mob besieging an Apple store in Sydney with participants holding a 'Wake Up' placard. "Another Samsung stunt", was what majority of us thought. Till we learnt that it was the Waterloo based BlackBerry maker Research In Motion, which had sponsored the whole event! Clearly the world was laughing at RIM to have even attempted a Samsung! The whole idea



Flash mob outside Apple store

behind the campaign was to prod corporate users to use a BlackBerry handset instead of the more flashy touchscreen phones. They even created a website for this campaign which has a rolling speech. One line says "Business is no longer just a suit-wearing, cubicle-sitting, card-carrying kind of pursuit," Gee! BlackBerry, you don't say!

Where the bridges sway and roads are wonky

So Apple decided that it was about time they got rid of their competitor's Maps app. Google Maps was chucked out of the latest iOS iteration. Now while showcasing iOS Maps app at WWDC in June this year, it was touted as the most "Beautiful" (word repeated 7 times in the presentation) mapping solution built from the ground-up, with in-house cartographers! We don't know which school they went to, because when someone decided to check out Mumbai, all we had were four major roads, and no points of interest. A lot of Apple fanboys quickly came to its rescue on Twitter, stating stuff like, "Oh c'mon, Apple Maps has just launched. It took Google Maps six years to get where it is now." Well we say Apple Maps work just fine for a few conditions: one, if you suddenly found yourself in the 70s or two, the Twilight Zone.

But seriously, why chuck out a good service when yours is barely in beta? At the end of the day a maps app should do only one thing right – show the correct satellite images. But what users got instead were wavy bridges, cloud cover on certain North European cities, hardly any detail in some Indian cities and so on. Between Apple maps and the local paan wala, we will still prefer the latter for navigation!

Apple CEO Tim Cook issued an apology and even suggested: "While we're